

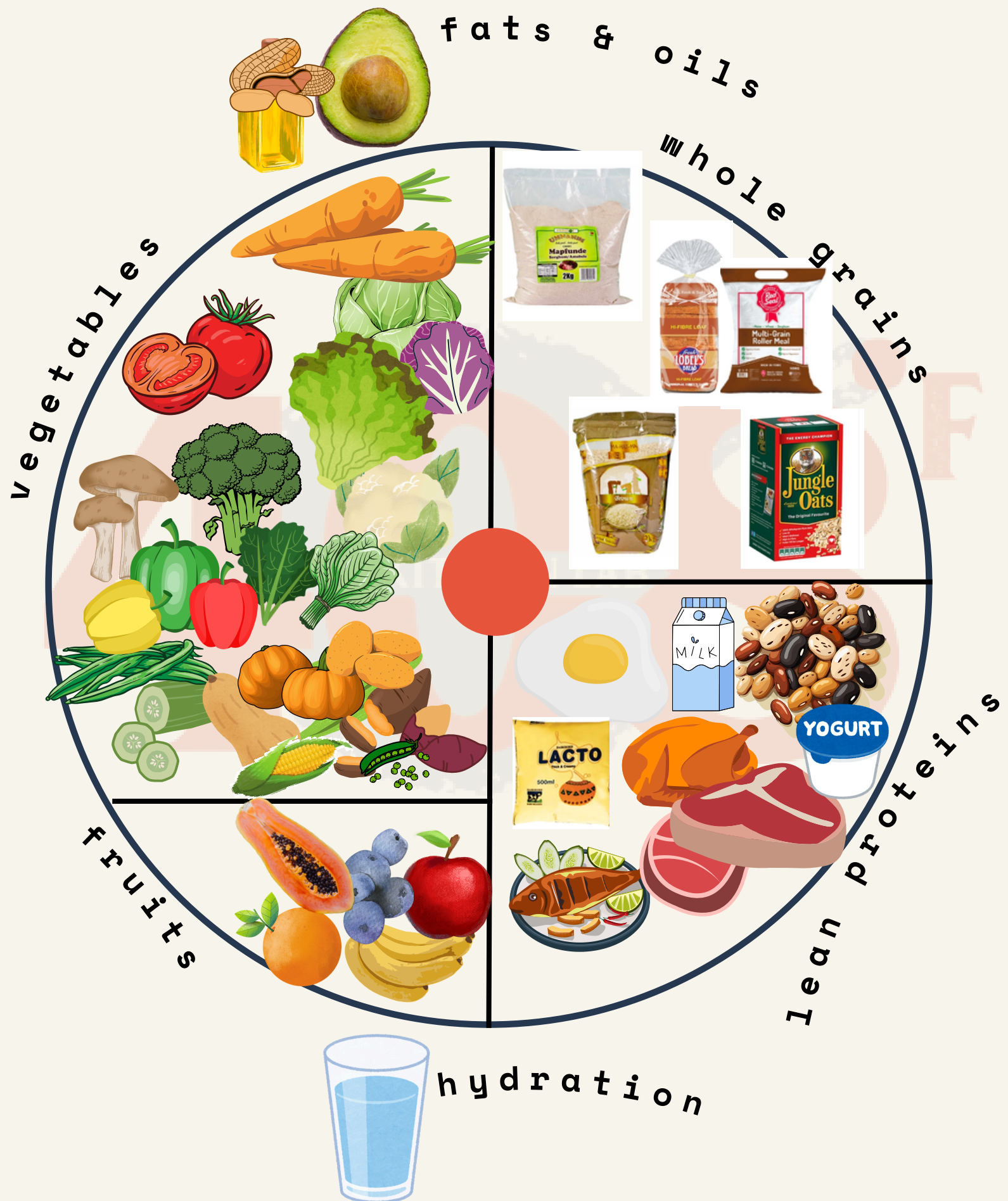


HEALTHY EATING PLATE FRAMEWORK



HEALTHY EATING PLATE

your guide for building a balanced plate. adapted from NHLBI



BUILDING A BALANCED, NUTRIENT-DENSE PLATE

fill nearly half of the plate with a variety of:

- **non-starchy vegetables** such as: rape, covo, tsunga, pumpkin leaves (muboora), spinach, broccoli, cauliflower, cabbage (red/white cabbage), okra(derere) lettuce, carrots, tomatoes, mushrooms, carrots, red/green/yellow peppers, peas.
- **starchy vegetables** like butternut, sweet potatoes (mbambaira), pumpkin, green mealies (chibage)
- **add fruits** - oranges, bananas, apples, blueberries, pears, guavas, masawu, tsubvu
- vegetables & fruits are rich in vitamins and minerals, low in calories and rich in fiber important. having a variety and colourful plate ensures adequate intake of essential nutrients.

fill a quarter of the plate with whole grains high in fiber such as:

- whole grains such as brown rice, whole wheat bread/brown bread, multi grain roller meals, sadza rezviyo/mhunga, oats.
- whole grains are high in fiber and provide essential vitamins like B vitamins. helps in digestion and release energy at a slow steady rate.

fill a quarter of the plate with healthy, lean proteins such as:

- **animal sources:** chicken, fish & seafood, kapenta (matemba), eggs, lean cuts of beef and pork, goat meat, offals (gizzards, liver, kidneys, gizzards)
- **plant-based proteins:** sugar beans, nyemba (cowpeas), nyimo (Bambara groundnuts), nzungu (groundnuts/peanuts), pumpkin seeds (also a great healthy fat source), soya chunks. also great fiber sources*
- **traditional/cultural sources:** mopane worms (madora/amacimbi), termites (ishwa)
- **dairy** sources of protein e.g. milk, yoghurt, lacto.
- proteins are building blocks and important for muscle maintenance and repair. lean proteins are lower in saturated fats and calories and help meet protein intake without raising cholesterol levels

healthy fats include:

- use healthy oils such as sunflower, canola, olive oil, soybean
- focus on unsaturated fats such as avocado, peanut butter (dovi), and groundnuts
- limit use of trans and saturated fats found in butter/margarine, fast foods, and baked/deep-fried foods.
- fats are important for absorption of fat soluble vitamins (A, D, E and K), hormone production and for brain & cognitive function.

BUILDING A BALANCED, NUTRIENT-PLATE

hydration:

- water is a great choice for hydration with zero calories, aids in digestion and eliminating waste products.
- drink tea/coffee with little to no sugar.
- avoid sugary drinks like soda, fizzy drinks

limit processed foods and sugars – have in moderation:

- foods high in salt such as kapenta (matemba), noodles, cold meats (ham, salami, polony), salted maputi/nzungu
- refined, highly processed carbohydrates and with added sugars & salt such as sweet tea and juice, soft/fizzy drinks,
- refined grains like white bread, white rice and sugary cereals
- sweets and snacks like cake, cookies/biscuits, sweets, and chips.